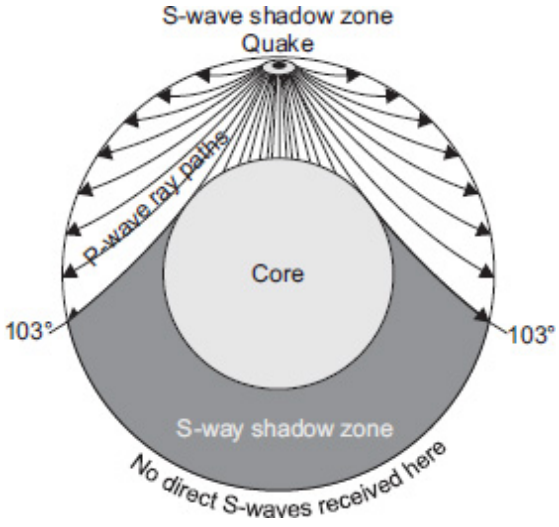


70. The thickness of the crust varies under the oceanic and continental areas. Oceanic crust is thinner (5 to 30 km thick) as compared to the continental crust (50 to 70 km thick). The continental crust is thicker in the areas of major mountain systems. It is as much as 70 to 100 km thick in the Himalayan region.
71. Crust is the outer thin layer with a total thickness between 30 and 50 km. The crust, along with the upper most solid part of mantle is called as Lithosphere whereas Asthenosphere is completely a part of mantle lies just below the Asthenosphere.
72. The outer covering of the crust is of **sedimentary material (granitic rocks)** and below that lie crystalline, igneous and metamorphic rocks which are **acidic** in nature. The lower layer of the crust consists of **basaltic and ultra-basic rocks**. The continents are composed of lighter silicates—silica + aluminium (also called 'sial') while the oceans have the heavier silicates—silica + magnesium (also called **'sima'**).
73. The three main layers of Earth include the crust (1 percent of Earth's volume), the mantle (84 percent), and the core (inner and outer combined, 15 percent). The outer layer of the mantle is partly **simatic** while the inner layer is composed of wholly **simatic ultrabasic rocks**. The density of the centre of the Earth yields densities of about 14 times that of water, which could be obtainable by compressing iron and nickel, but not surface type rocks. Core has the heaviest mineral materials of highest density, composed of **nickel and iron [nife]**.